

Watch that Move

PHOTOGRAPH: Jiten Gandhi, IMAGING: Parag Joshi

Prevention, as they say, is better than cure, and this goes double if you are a road warrior living off your laptop

Securing your laptop is easier said than done; the very fact that laptops are so mobile makes them attractive and easy targets. Losing your laptop is not just losing really expensive computer hardware—if your laptop is your main computer at work, then it can also mean the loss of several hundred hours of work. And if you happen to be a corporate hotshot (which you'd have to be to get one in the first place), there goes all your hush-hush company information.

It's a big bad world

Security means that you should be able to foresee the possible threats to your laptop and the data residing in it. Whether you take your laptop all over the world, or just from home to work and back, the fear of physical loss of the laptop is omnipresent.

Not all laptops are stolen and sent to the local chop-shop to be resold; smart thieves will target laptops to pick up data that is otherwise inaccessible from workstations behind company firewalls. Third-party software tools that will restrict logins and encrypt drives are your best bet against data thieves. The Bill Gates' of the world probably have a posse of security men guarding their laptops.

There are hardware locks available that will let you secure your laptop as you would your bags on a train. Also, using commonly available tools, you can ensure that even if it's stolen, your data remains safe.

Hardware paranoia

Securing your laptop is best achieved by locking it down... literally! Laptop manufacturers provide a little slot with each lap-

